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picks

while Assomull, CEO Marigold Group, which is set to launch French label La Bagagerie here, believes that the logo lobby is far from dying out, she sees a growing audience for smaller exclusive brands. "A lot of European brands are showing an interest in the Indian market," says Assomull.

So get ready to acquaint yourself with bejewelled footwear from Italian maestro Rene Caovilla and trendy threads from Pinko as Pradip Hirani of Kimaya prepares to bring these boutique brands to Mumbai and Delhi this year. "A trend that's slowly emerging all over the world is now being seen in India too.

People are shying away from in-your-face logos and looking for quiet luxury and quality," says Hirani, who besides retailing Malaysian designer Melinda Looi, is also in the process of finalising details with other niche players.

The arrival of Richard Stark's rock chic brand Chrome Hearts—

OL

Melinda
Looi

Malaysian designer Melinda Looi's couture collection offers chic cocktail dresses, tops and evening gowns

Accessorise yourself with labels that are nouveau, niche and all the rage

JUDITH LEIBER: The American luxury accessories brand, a favourite with Hollywood celebrities, creates hand-crafted jewelled minaudières and exotic handbags, also known as the Rolls Royce of handbags



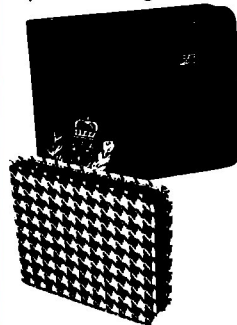
RENE CAOILLA: An Italian shoe designer—considered to be a sculptor of sophisticated footwear—combines precious stones and crystals with Milanese know-how in his label.



DIANE VON FÜRSTENBERG: This American label, famous for its iconic wrap dress, also sells swimwear in funky colours and bright prints



COMME DES GARÇONS: Accessories from Japanese designer Rei Kawakubo's label include houndstooth wallets, subversive foil prints and bags



CHROME HEARTS: Exotic woods, sterling silver, precious stones, leather and chrome detailing combine in edgy sunglasses, a favourite with rockstars



UNITED NUDE: Rem D Koolhaas and Galahad Clark's label designs sculptural footwear, bags and accessories. Unusual designs meet functionality in their creations.

